



Nuran

Talk & Learn

User Manual

For parents, caregivers, and everyone who helps

Once installed, works fully offline · No account · No ads · No tracking
Nuran does not upload child data



Welcome

Nuran is a talking and learning app for a child who communicates by pointing. Your child taps large picture buttons and the device speaks each word slowly and clearly. Around that sit gentle learning games, a few calm play games, and caregiver tools: add personal words with your photos and voice, put the family in with real faces, and keep everything safely backed up.

Two promises shape everything in this manual:

- **Everyday child use is recoverable.** Normal removal is reversible, settings live behind a caregiver gate, and local snapshots provide another recovery path.
- **It is private by design.** No account, ads, analytics, or tracking. Once the app is installed, it needs no internet connection. Nuran does not upload child data; a caregiver can deliberately export and share a backup file.

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Two-minute quick start

Open the app, tap **Quick setup**, tap **Talk**, and tap any word — the device speaks it. That is the whole idea. Everything else in this manual just makes that richer.

1 First-time setup

The first time the app opens, a short welcome asks one question: quick or careful?

A Quick setup — best defaults, done in one tap.

The best offline English voice Nuran can identify; a clear, slow speaking style; Best available pictures (your photo, then Mulberry, then Nuran's complete set); moving play activities hidden; and cheerful celebrations. Recommended when you want to hand the device over right away.

B Choose settings — four short steps with visible choices.

1 • Voice: choose an actual installed device voice, then hear Warm & slow, Clear & friendly, or Calm & steady. **2 • Pictures:** Best available, Mulberry first, or Original Nuran symbols, with previews. **3 • Movement:** Still, Gentle, or Playful, with a live demo. **4 • Celebrations:** Quiet, Cheerful, or Festive, plus the celebration picture and a Try it button.

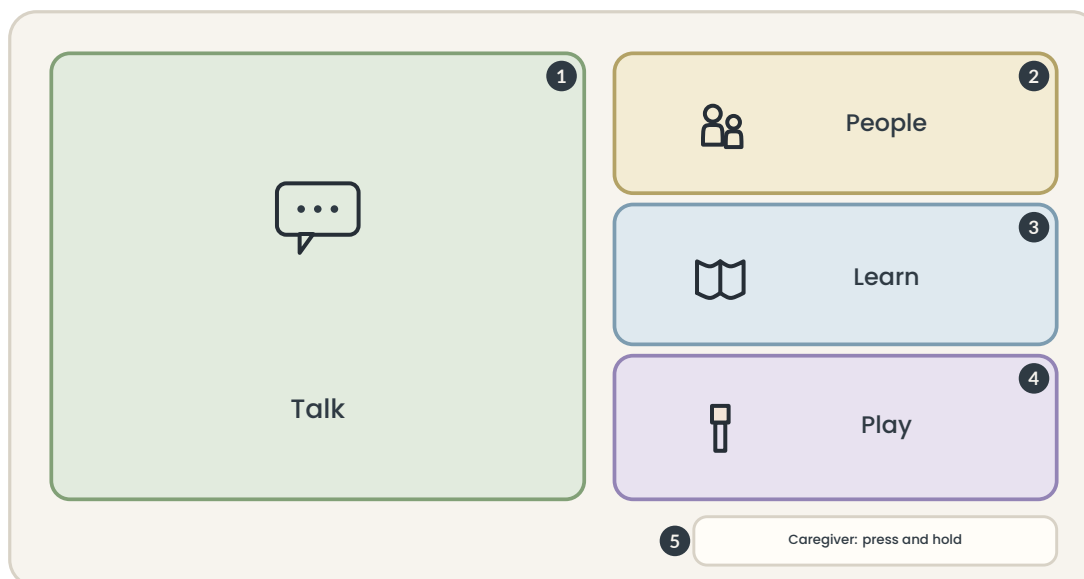
Nothing here is final: every choice can be changed later in Settings, and the wizard itself can be re-run any time from the caregiver area (**Setup wizard**). Re-running it and choosing quick setup *replaces* the current voice, pictures, motion, and celebration choices — the button says so plainly.

Why motion is off by default

Many autistic children find on-screen movement overwhelming, so Nuran's moving play activities stay hidden until a caregiver decides otherwise. Choosing Gentle or Playful unlocks Sky Pop and Blocks; choosing Still keeps the available play activities static.

2 The home screen

Four large buttons — **Talk, People, Learn, Play** — and nothing else. The same things are always in the same places, which matters more than it looks: predictability is what makes the app feel safe.



- 1 **Talk** opens the word buttons — where your child communicates. (Section 3)
- 2 **People** shows family photos that speak their names when tapped. (Section 5)
- 3 **Learn** holds short matching games that teach words gently. (Section 4)
- 4 **Play** holds calm reward games — balloons, memory, paint, music. (Section 4)
- 5 **Caregiver: press and hold.** Hold for a few seconds — a thin line fills while you hold — to open the caregiver area. A quick tap does nothing, so a child cannot wander in by accident. (Section 6)

The optional Help button

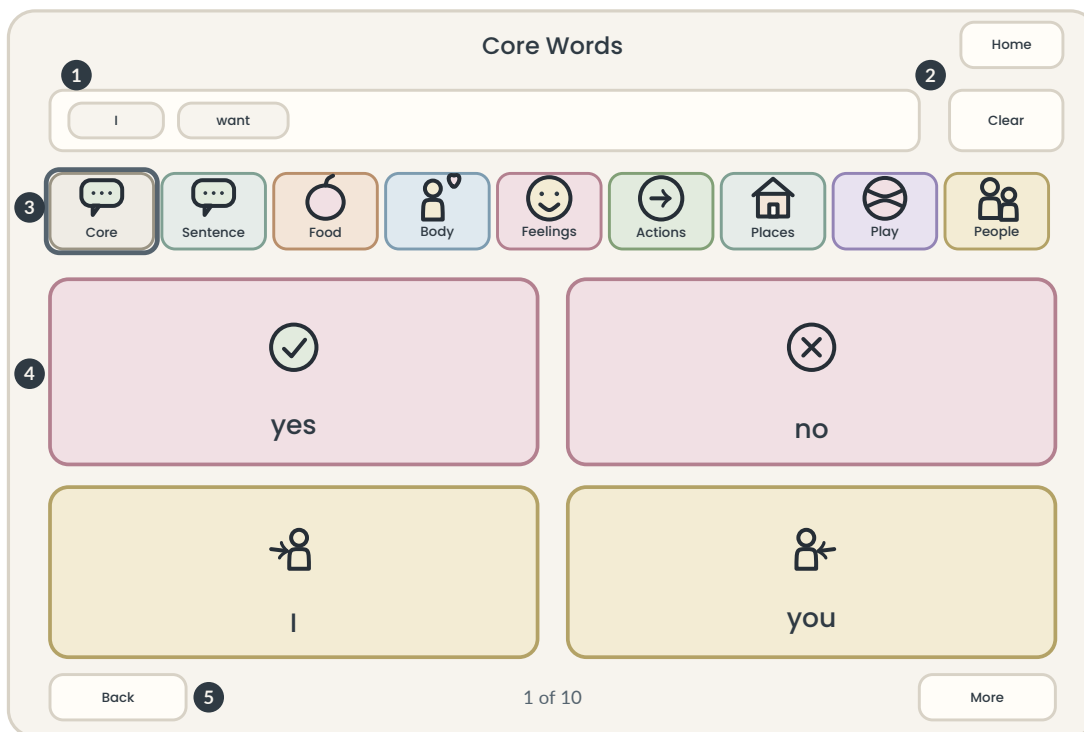
A fifth home button, **Help**, rings a loud alarm so a child can call a caregiver from another room. It starts hidden; turn it on in Settings when your child is ready for it. (Section 5)

Talk is never more than one tap away

On every child screen — Learn, Play, People — a **Talk** button sits in the top bar, always in the same spot. Mid-game, mid-song, your child can always reach words. In Settings this can become a small *dock* that also pins up to three quick words (Help, Stop, and Bathroom to start), or be turned off entirely.

3 Talking: words & sentences

Tap a word, hear the word — spoken slowly, the way a speech therapist models it. **Core Words** preserves the Project Core 36. Tap **Sentence Words** beside it for *is, am, are, a* on page one and the other small words that join messages together.



- 1 **The sentence bar.** Every tapped word also lands here, in order. Tap the bar itself and the device speaks the whole line — “*I want cookie.*” It holds up to eight words and follows your child across groups, so a sentence can start in Core Words and finish in Food.
- 2 **Save / Clear.** Clear empties the bar. *Holding* Save for a moment (with at least two words in the bar) turns the sentence into a single button in a **My Phrases** group — so “*I need the bathroom*” becomes one tap forever after. Holding, not tapping, so stray taps cannot create buttons.
- 3 **The group strip.** One colored button per word group; the current group wears the darker outline. Sentence Words begins with *is, am, are, a*. Your child moves between groups alone — no caregiver needed. People, the Visual Routine scene (Section 7), and the Keyboard (when enabled) appear here too.
- 4 **Word buttons.** Picture and written word together, color-coded by type: people words yellow, actions green, feelings pink. Words you add appear here too, wearing their group’s color.
- 5 **Back / More** turn pages when a group holds more words than one screen.

The pinned row

Certain words matter too much to ever be a page-turn away. **Bathroom** starts pinned beneath the sentence bar on every Talk page; caregivers can pin others from Words & groups.

Tip

Colors are consistent everywhere: a word keeps its color across screens, so hands learn where things are before reading does.

4 Learn & Play

Learn — short games that teach words

Learn offers three matching games: **Match Pictures** (hear a word, tap its picture), **Match Words** (match the written word), and **Match Colors**. Each session is eight friendly rounds. Two design choices do the real teaching:

- **Wrong taps never scold.** Nothing buzzes, nothing frowns. After two tries the right answer gently shows itself, your child taps it, and the game moves on — so every round ends in success. (Practitioners call this errorless learning.)
- **Games grow with your child.** Sessions start with easy, familiar words and widen as answers come faster. Progress is stored only on the device, and the caregiver Progress screen shows it as a picture, not a report card.

When a session ends, a small button offers “**Use (word) in Talk**” — the word your child practiced most that session. One tap opens the real Talk board with that word highlighted, so the game quietly turns into communication. (This bridge can be turned off in Settings.)

If a learning language is added in Settings (Section 8), an extra tile — *Arabic words* or *Somali words* — appears in Learn.

Play — calm reward games

Play holds small games with no losing condition: **Balloons** (tap to pop), **Memory**, **Paint**, and **Music** (a little piano). If a caregiver has allowed motion, two moving games join them: **Sky Pop** (drifting balloons) and **Blocks**. Caregivers can hide any game individually in Settings — hidden games show a friendly “the games are resting” note rather than an error.

The learning break

The app defaults to no play limit. If a caregiver chooses 15, 20, 30, or 45 minutes (30 is the recommended timed choice), a gentle warning appears two minutes early; then a calm *First / Then* screen offers one short learning game with a visible countdown, and the play games come back afterward. First/Then visual transitions are a standard, well-studied support for autistic children — firm, predictable, and kind.

5 People & the Help button

People

People shows the family as large photo tiles — real faces work far better than symbols for social words. Tapping a photo speaks the person's name, in your recorded voice if you added one, and the name joins the sentence bar just like a word: *"I want mom."* People starts empty; adding the family takes about a minute per person (Section 7).

The Help alarm

The Help button starts hidden. When a caregiver turns it on (Settings → *Help button on the home screen*), it joins the home screen. Tapping it turns the screen dark with a large "Help!" message and the device rings insistently — your child's way of calling you from another room.

- To answer it: go to your child first, then **press and hold** the button on the alert screen until it releases. A quick tap will not stop it — that is deliberate, so the child cannot silence their own call for help.
- After a caregiver answers the alarm, a small reminder banner stays on the home screen until it is cleared. It survives a page reload during the same open app session, but closing the app or browser can clear it.
- The alarm sounds even when the app's sound setting is off.

Good to know

The alarm is loud on purpose. If it startles your child the first time, practice it together once so they know what their Help button does — and that it works.

6 The caregiver area

On the home screen, press and hold **Caregiver**: press and hold for a few seconds. A thin line fills along the button while you hold; when it completes, the caregiver menu opens. The gate is a speed bump, not a lock — it only exists so stray taps cannot change your child’s setup. (For a real lock, see *Lock device* below.)

Menu item	What it does
Today	The first stop: backup health, recently used words, personal-voice coverage, the Visual Routine, and learning activity — each with its next useful action.
Add a word	New vocabulary with a photo and optional recording. (Section 7)
Words & groups	Edit, move, pin, or remove words; rename, reorder, hide, or create groups.
People	Add family members, their photos, and recorded names.
Settings	Talk access, voice, motion, layout — everything. (Section 8)
Visual Routine	Create one family-photo communication scene. (Section 7)
Back up	Saves everything into one file — do this weekly. (Section 9)
Restore	Rebuilds the app from a backup file or an automatic snapshot.
Recover deleted	Everything ever removed rests here; one tap brings it back.
Progress	Which words your child uses most. Local only — a picture, not a report card.
Translate & record	Add another language word by word, with your own recordings. (Section 8)
Device check	Plain-language health checks. Run it after installing.
Storage	Space used, and which photos or recordings use it.
Lock device	Step-by-step instructions for the built-in child lock: Guided Access on iPad/iPhone, App pinning on Android — so the device stays inside Nuran.
Setup wizard	Re-run the four-step setup: actual device voice, pictures, motion, and celebrations, with previews and demos. (Section 1)

For keyboard and switch users

Every press-and-hold control also works with a single keyboard or switch activation — the app simply asks “Continue?” first, so one accidental activation can never open the caregiver area or silence the Help alarm.

7 Adding words, people & the Visual Routine

Adding a word — five small steps

- 1 **Open the caregiver area, tap Add a word, and type the word.**
Single words work best: *pasta, blanket, swing*. If it already exists you get a gentle warning. Interrupted halfway? Your draft is saved automatically.
- 2 **Choose its group.**
Your child will find it there, wearing that group's color.
- 3 **Add a photo — optional, but powerful.**
A photo of *your child's actual* cup beats any symbol. Snap photos with the device camera first, then choose them here. Without a photo the word shows as a symbol or a simple letter tile.
- 4 **Record your voice — optional.**
Tap once to start, again to stop. Skip it and the device speaks the word by itself in the slow voice, which works fine. Family names usually sound nicer recorded.
- 5 **Tap Hear it to preview, then Save word.**
It appears in the app immediately.

Adding a person

Caregiver area → **People** → **Add a person**: name, an optional “who they are” (mom, grandma), a clear photo of their face, and optionally their name in your voice. Saved people become large photo tiles on the People screen.

Managing groups

In **Words & groups**, tap **Edit groups** to rename, reorder, hide, or add groups — *School, Grandma's house*. A new group appears in the strip as soon as it contains its first word.

The Visual Routine — one photo, four words

Caregiver area → **Visual Routine**: choose one familiar photo (the breakfast table, the bathtub), give it a short title, and attach up to four words. The scene joins the Talk group strip as its own chip; opening it shows the photo large with its words in four fixed corner areas — communication anchored in a real, familiar moment. Speech researchers call these *visual scene displays*; they are especially helpful for early communicators. One scene for now, on purpose: see how your child takes to it.

Tip

Start small and personal. Ten words your child cares about — their foods, their people, their comfort items — beat a hundred generic ones. You can always add more as they grow.

8 Settings

Everything saves instantly; there is no save button to forget. All settings live behind the caregiver gate, grouped by what they affect. Highlights, group by group:

Group	What lives there
Talk & access	Talk Anytime (the persistent Talk button, the custom dock with up to three quick words, or off) • Sentence bar shown or hidden • Help button on the home screen • Keyboard (big letter keys that speak what your child types — the bridge to spelling) • Talk tiles picture-and-word or word-only • Buttons per screen : 4 (recommended), 6, 9, or 12.
Voice & sound	Device voice : Automatic picks the strongest offline English voice Nuran can identify, or save one of the installed voices listed by name. Speaking style — Warm & slow, Clear & friendly, or Calm & steady — adjusts that voice's speed and pitch; the styles are not fake replacement voices. Hear a sample checks both choices. Sound off is quiet mode for public places (words still appear; the Help alarm still rings). A family recording always wins.
Pictures & language	Pictures on buttons : Best available (default) uses your photo, then Mulberry — a professional AAC picture set included free — then Nuran's complete symbol set. Mulberry-first and Original Nuran modes are also available. Learning language : add Arabic or Somali; controls stay in English.
Learn & Play	The Learn-to-Talk bridge on or off • Play time before a learning break (off / 15 / 20 / 30 recommended / 45 minutes) • Games shown in Play — hide any game individually.
Motion & celebrations	Motion : None (default), Gentle, or Full — moving games stay hidden at None no matter what • Celebration picture and energy (Quiet, Cheerful, Festive).
Data reminders	How often the caregiver area nudges you to back up: every 3, 7, 14, or 30 days.

Another language, in your voice

Translate & record (caregiver area) walks through the vocabulary word by word: type the translation, record it in your own voice, done. Synthetic Somali availability and pronunciation vary by device and may not match your family's Mogadishu accent. A family recording always takes priority, so your child can learn in a familiar voice. Recorded translations power the Arabic or Somali tile in Learn.

9 Keeping everything safe

Your child's vocabulary is protected three times over, and the first two layers need nothing from you:

- 1 **Nothing really deletes.**
Removing a word, group, or person only hides it. **Recover deleted** → *Bring back*, and it returns exactly as it was, photo and recording included.
- 2 **Automatic snapshots.**
While open, the app quietly saves a full snapshot every hour — the last 24 hours, plus one per day for two weeks. **Restore** lists them; pick a time and the app returns to exactly how it was. A safety copy is taken before every restore, so even restoring can be undone.
- 3 **The backup file — the only step that is yours.**
Snapshots live on the device, so a lost or broken device takes them along. **Back up** creates one file holding every word, photo, recording, translation, learning-progress record, and setting, and opens the share sheet — save it to iCloud Drive or Files. On any device, **Restore** rebuilds everything from that file. **Do it after first setup, then weekly.** It is one tap, and the Today screen reminds you.

If the app ever opens empty

Rarely, a device clears browser storage. If an on-device snapshot is available, the app offers it; **Restore** also lets you choose a backup file you saved elsewhere. Nuran shows a recovery or restart path instead of leaving an unexplained blank screen.

10 Fixes & helping your child learn

Quick fixes

If this happens	Do this
No sound on tap	Check the device volume and mute switch, then Settings → Sound → On. Tap one word yourself – devices sometimes need one tap after reopening before speech starts.
Voice sounds robotic	Open Settings → Voice & sound and choose another installed Device voice ; Automatic uses the best one Nuran can identify. On iPad, add more under Settings → Accessibility → Spoken Content → Voices. Then try the speaking styles. For important words, record your own voice: recordings always win.
A word or group vanished	Caregiver area → Recover deleted → Bring back.
Photo would not attach	Try again or pick another photo. Camera photos and screenshots both work.
Microphone will not record	Allow the microphone for Nuran in the device Settings. Recording is optional – without it the app speaks words by itself.
Moving games are missing	Motion is set to None. That is a choice, not a bug – raise it in Settings → Motion & celebrations if your child enjoys movement.
Games are “resting”	They were hidden in Settings → Learn & Play, or a learning break is running. Both are caregiver choices.
Looks like a web page	It was opened in the browser instead of from its icon. Use the Home Screen icon; if there is none, redo <i>Add to Home Screen</i> .
Help alarm will not stop	Press and <i>hold</i> the button on the alert until it completes.
Child keeps leaving the app	Caregiver area → Lock device shows how to keep the device inside Nuran (Guided Access / App pinning).

The one habit that matters most: model it

Children learn AAC by watching people they love use it – not by being quizzed. Use the app yourself while you speak: tap *more* as you offer more, tap *all done* as lunch ends, build *I want ball* in the sentence bar while saying it out loud. Follow your child’s interests, keep it pressure-free, and let them push the buttons that matter to them. Every tap you model is a small lesson that this thing on the table is *their voice*, and that it works.

App link <https://ngev.github.io/nuran-aac/>

Free and open source (MIT) · Made with love for Nuran